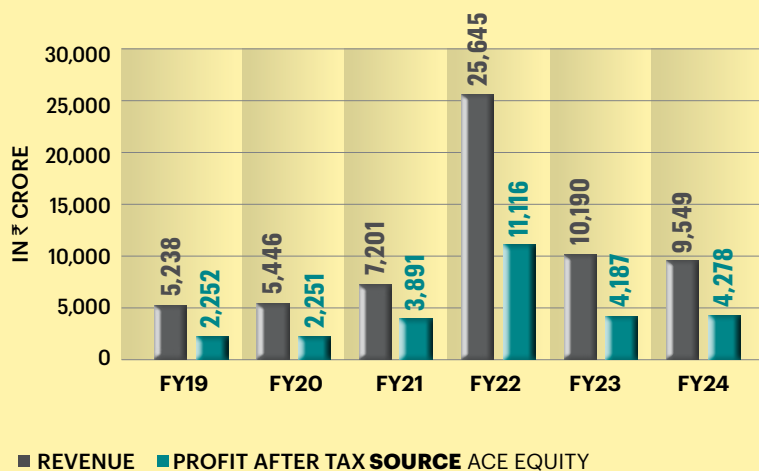




THE WINDFALL

- SII saw a big jump in revenue and profits during the pandemic because of the Covishield vaccine, but these have since dipped



estimates, the central government paid SII ₹25,583 crore for around 2 billion doses of the Covishield vaccine. But Poonawalla was under no illusion that the pandemic boost to revenues would be hard to sustain. “In fact, in December 2021, we shut down production despite having hundreds of millions of doses in reserve,” he says. That’s because demand was driven predominantly by governments and their vaccination drive. “The private market for these vaccines is always small,” says Poonawalla.

To make up for the slump in Co-